

PROFESSIONAL CONDUCT – PROFESSIONAL USE OF EMAIL

In order to communicate effectively and professionally with our families and students, Loudoun County School Board employees are expected to adhere to the following requirements regarding electronic mail communications:

A. Signature Format

1. An email signature shall be used when sending an email from an LCPS account. The following signature format shall be applied to the bottom of all emails to include out-of-office replies and auto-replies. All users of the LCPS email system must adhere to these standards. Directions for formatting email signatures can be found at the bottom of this page in the LCPS Brand Guidelines.

Sample Signature

[Honorific (OPTIONAL)], [Employee Name], [Professional Credential (OPTIONAL)],
[Title]
[(Gender Identifying Pronouns (OPTIONAL))]
[School or Division]
[Office and/or Department, where applicable]
[Address]
[Phone]
[Work Cell Phone] (OPTIONAL)
[Fax] (OPTIONAL)
[Email address] (OPTIONAL)
[School/Department website address] (OPTIONAL)
[School/Department social media address (ex: Follow us on: @lcpsofficial)]
(OPTIONAL)

CONFIDENTIALITY / PRIVACY NOTICE – This email and attachments may contain confidential and/or legally protected information. If you are not the intended recipient, or the person responsible for providing the information to the intended recipient, you are notified that any disclosure, copying, distribution of this information, and any other use of or reliance upon it, are strictly prohibited. If you have received this email or attachments in error, please notify the sender immediately. All correspondence with Loudoun County Public Schools, including email, may be subject to disclosure in accordance with the Virginia Freedom of Information Act.

2. The expectations outlined in this regulation also apply when utilizing an out-of-office message.

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3. If a position requires any additional statements following their email signature, such statements must be approved by the employee's supervisor. Certain content is not permitted in an LCPS email signature. This includes but is not limited to:

- a. Personal quotes, phrases, or slogans;
- b. Spam;
- c. Non-LCPS content, including links to other school programs;
- d. Graphics, photos, emojis or background imagery except as otherwise provided below; and
- e. Copyrighted material

B. Virginia Freedom of Information Act. Information about the Virginia Freedom of Information Act shall be included in the signature for all LCPS employees, School Board Members and School Board Aides.

C. Optional Content. The following items may be included in an LCPS employee's email signature as optional content:

1. Honorifics (including Miss, Ms, Mrs., Mr., or Mx.) used prior to a name or gender-identifying pronouns (to include, she/her/hers, he/him/his, they/them/theirs) used after a name, for the purpose of clarifying how students, parents, or other employees should refer to them;

2. Professional honorifics (including Dr. or Hon.) or credentials (e.g., M.A., Ed.D., Ph.D., MBA, RN, BSN, LPN, LPC, or J.D.) are permitted when related to an employee's LCPS position. Such professional credentials may include a professional license, academic degree or accreditation;

3. Division cell phone numbers;

4. Division fax numbers;

5. The employee's Division email address;

6. School or Department website addresses;

7. Approved Division- or school-administered social media addresses for schools or departments, which are consistent with the links used on the Division's or school's website;

8. Division, department, or school logos;

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9. The mission, vision, or motto of the Division or of an employee's specific school; and

10. Links to class-based pages in Schoology.

D. Questions. Questions related to the content of an email signature should be directed to an employee's immediate supervisor. To the extent a position requires additional information in an employee's LCPS email signature, such information must be approved by the employee's immediate supervisor. Technical support related to the use of formatting of an email signature should be directed to the LCPS Support Desk.

E. Formatting examples are found in the LCPS Brand Guidelines.

Issued: 8/14/23

Cross Ref: Policy [7560](#), Professional Conduct